LESSON 4

Ode to Joy

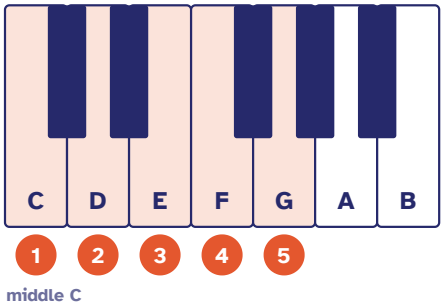
A tune from Beethoven's Ninth Symphony, first played in Vienna in 1824. The words here are our own.

IN THIS SONG **the staff** **the Queen's sign** **five fingers: C to G** **4/4**

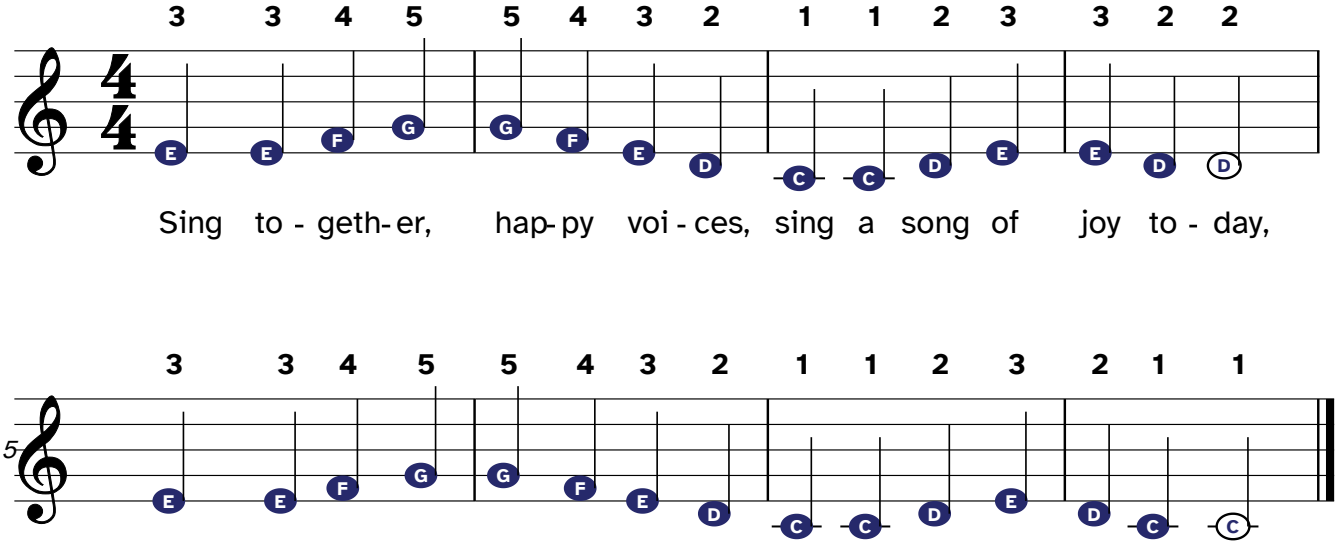
LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen to the whole song once, then hum along the second time.

1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing to each note. Sing it with the words, then on the letter names.



Your hand: the C position. Thumb on middle C, a finger on each key up to G: all five.
The staff arrives. Five lines, and the Queen's sign at the start: her curl wraps round line 2, the note G. The letters still sit inside the notes.



- [ ] Listened and pointed
- [ ] Sang it with the words
- [ ] Sang the letter names

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap them and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

THE TIME

4/4

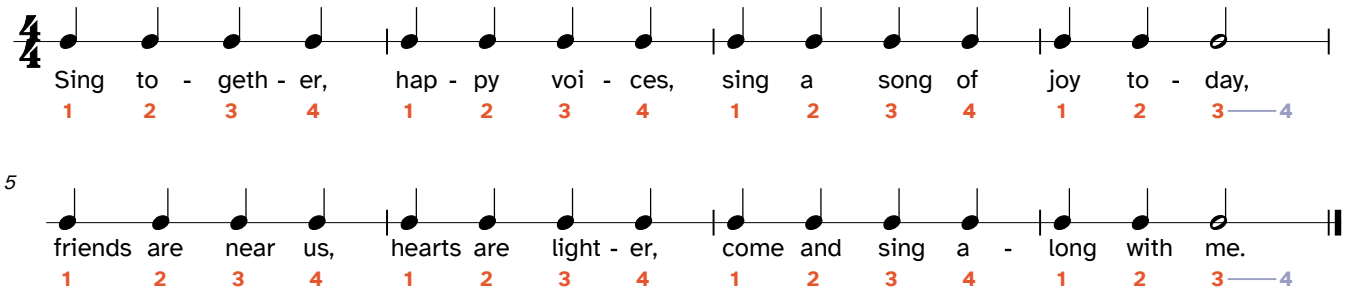
Top 4: four beats in every bar.

Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

THE NOTES

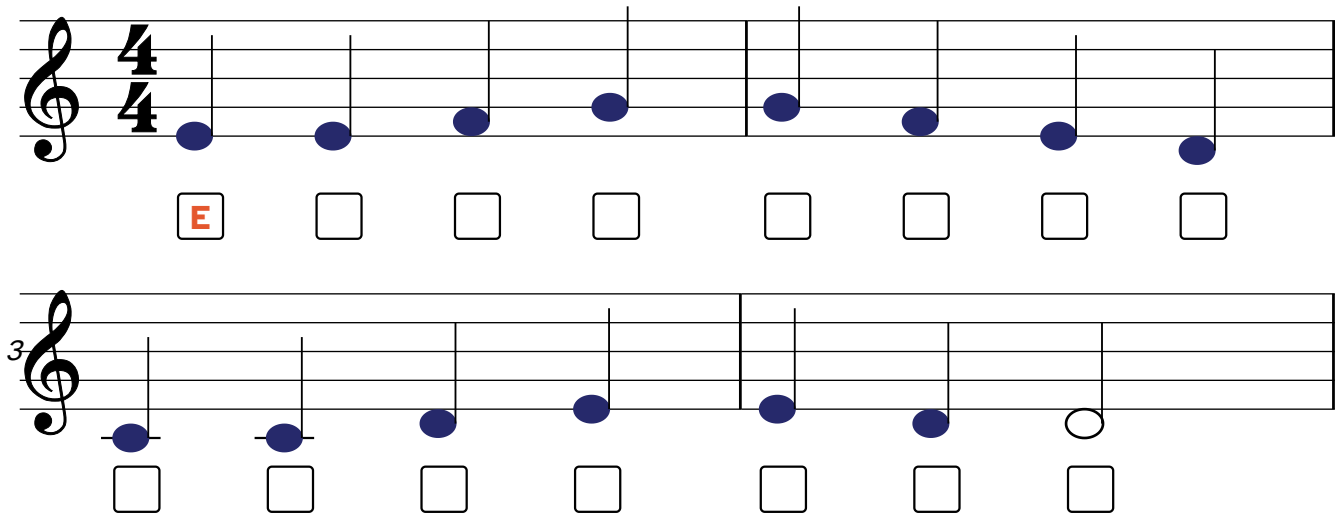
crotchet: walk — 1 beat ●

minim: hold — 2 beats ●●



THE NOTES

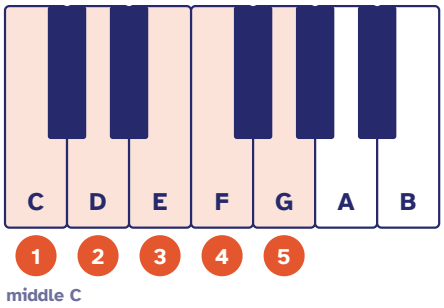
On the staff now: write the letter name under each note of the first four bars. E sits on the bottom line; G on line 2.



- ☐ **Said it in time**
- ☐ **Clapped and counted**
- ☐ **Wrote the letter names**
- ☐ **Found E and G on their lines**

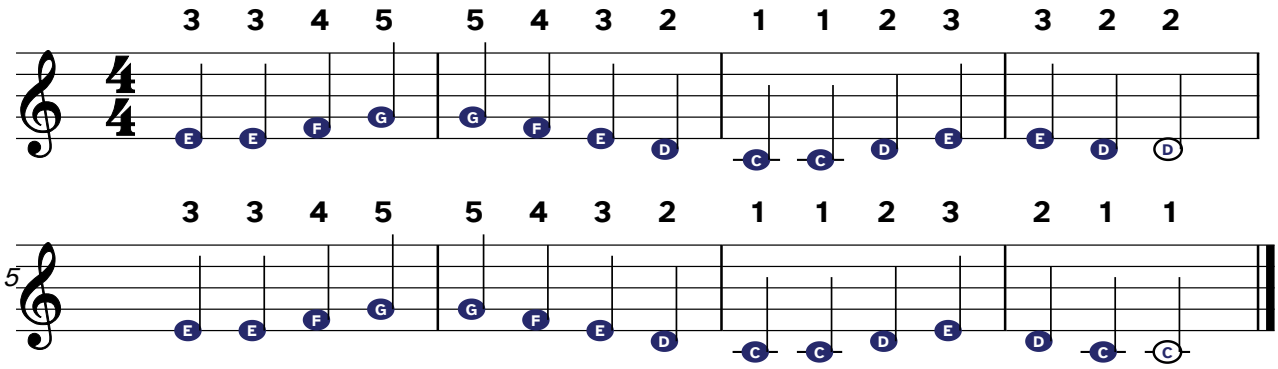
3 Play it

All five fingers in the C position: the right hand, then the left.

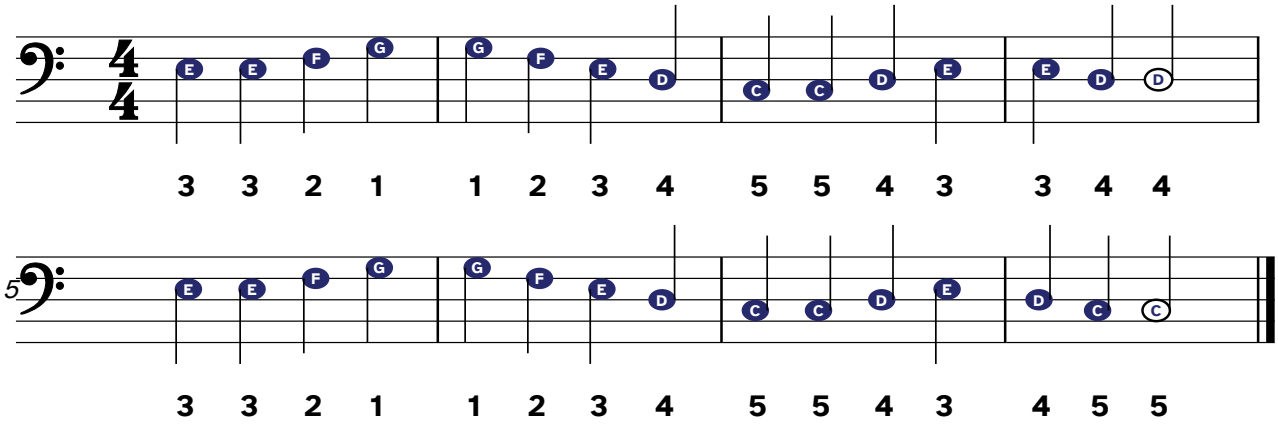


Right hand: thumb on middle C, 1 2 3 4 5 up to G. **Left hand:** an octave lower, on the King's staff: his sign's two dots wrap round F. Thumb on G, down to 5 on C.

R RIGHT HAND the C position



L LEFT HAND the King's staff, an octave lower



4 · CHECK

- ☐ I can say and clap it
- ☐ I can sing it with the words
- ☐ I can find E and G on the staff

I can play it:

- ☐ Right hand ☐ Left hand

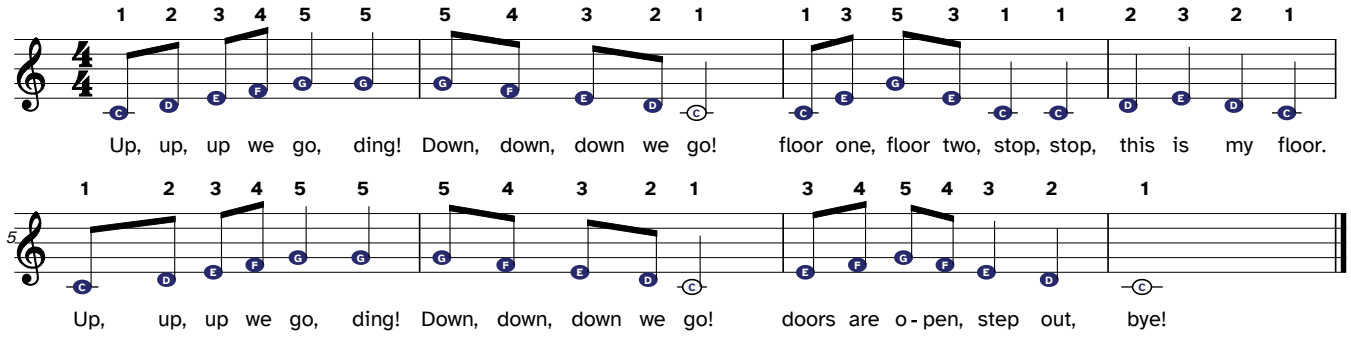
TEACHER ☐ Pass ☐ Not yet

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways, then take a first look at the next lesson.

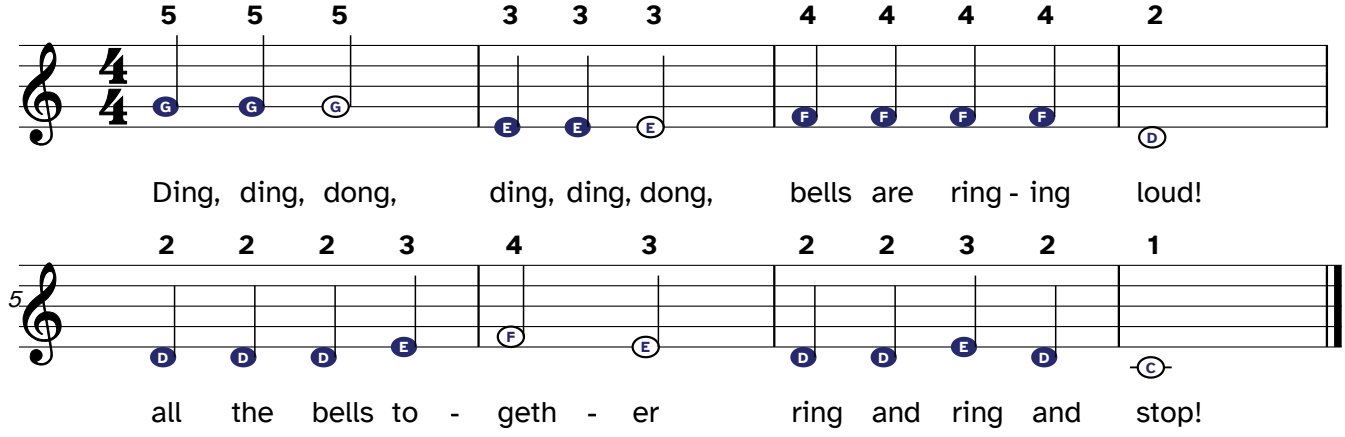
THE LIFT

A lift ride, quick and cheerful: all five fingers run up to G and back down, then hop between floors.



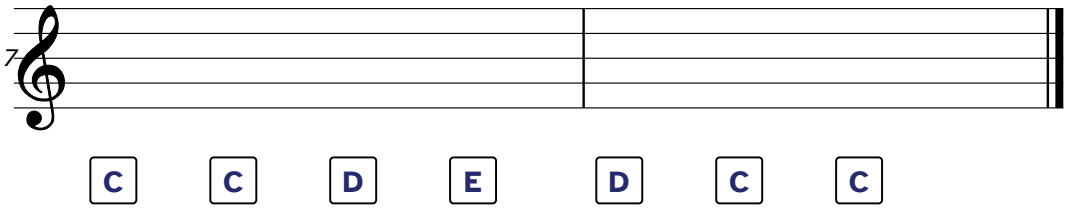
RING THE BELLS

Bright and ringing, a peek at Lesson 5: the same note again and again, then long notes to hold.



DRAW IT ON THE STAFF

The letter names are in the boxes. Draw each note above its box, on its line or in its space: C on its own little line under the staff, D just under the bottom line, E on the bottom line.



C C D E D C C

- [ ] Played the first tune
- [ ] Played the second tune
- [ ] Drew the notes on the staff